TECHNICAL PROPOSAL

Enterprise Business Listing Aggregator

One searchable library of business-for-sale listings that you own, with a full history of every change and a growing network of qualified buyers.

Prepared for	Aaron, Business Broker and Founder	**Date**	October 2026
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1. Summary

This proposal describes a website that collects business-for-sale listings from many places into one searchable library that you own. It replaces tools like Airtable, remembers how every listing changes over time, and turns visitors into a growing list of registered business buyers for your brokerage.

You told us the most important thing is a system that can keep adding new sources, state by state, up to hundreds, **without being rebuilt each time**. Phase 1 builds exactly that foundation. We start with one source, **CatchBuys**. Once the system is built and tested, we add **one more source**. History tracking and buyer activity tracking start from the very first day. Removing duplicate listings (the same business appearing twice) comes in Phase 2.

2. What You Asked For and How We Deliver It

What you asked for	What we will do	When
1. Better data sources	Start with CatchBuys. At the start we confirm its price, coverage and what you are allowed to show on your site. After the system is built, we add one more source. More broker sources follow state by state.	Phase 1; more sources in Phase 3
2. Easy to add new sources	Each source plugs into the same system. Adding one later means building one small connector, not rebuilding the website.	Phase 1; duplicate removal in Phase 2
3. History and market insight	From day one we record every change: price, seller earnings, revenue, status and dates. Reports such as price multiples, days on market and broker activity come later.	Recording: Phase 1; reports: Phase 3
4. Buyer accounts and tracking	Buyers register and log in. We record what they search for, view and save. Saved searches, alerts and buyer profiles come next.	Phases 1 and 2
5. Ownership and costs	You own the code, the data and the accounts. Monthly costs are in Section 8.	Phase 1

3. Where the Listings Come From

Official data feeds first. We begin with CatchBuys, which provides listings through a direct data connection (called an API). While we build and test the system, it is the only source. Then we choose **one more source together with you** and connect it, which proves the system can grow. After that, local broker websites are added state by state in Phase 3. Where possible we use official feeds or agreements instead of copying data from websites.

Why permissions matter. Each source has rules about what you may show publicly, whether Google may list those pages, and how long you may keep the data. We record these rules for every source and build them into the system. This is a technical review, not legal advice, so please have your lawyer read each agreement.

4. How the System Is Organized

Think of it as an assembly line. Listings come in from different sources, get cleaned into one standard format, are stored with their full history, and then appear on your website.

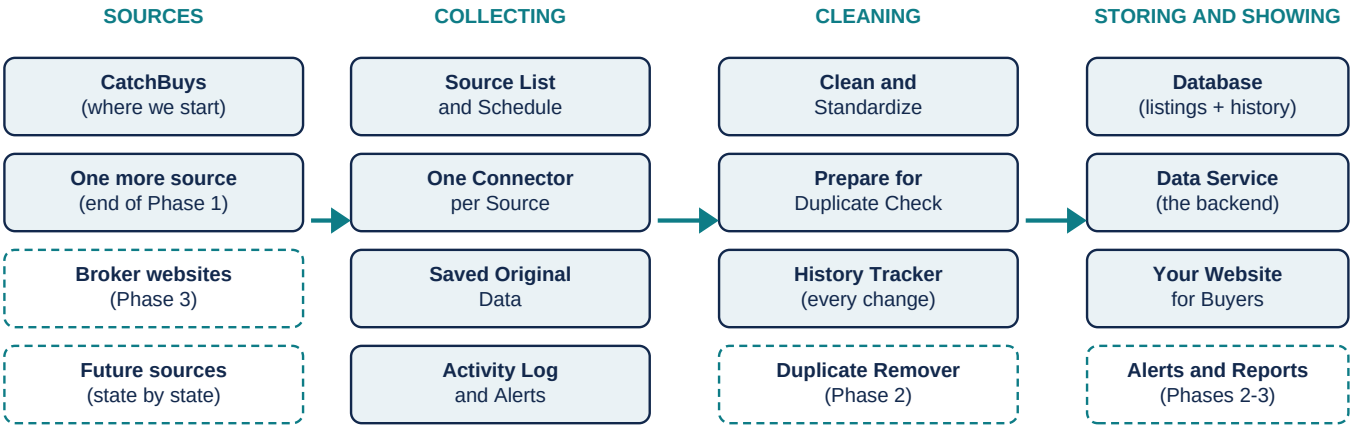

Figure 1. The same steps apply to every source. Dashed boxes arrive in later phases.

- **One connector per source:** each source gets its own small connector. The rest of the system never needs to change.
- **Source list:** a control panel showing every source, how often it updates, and whether it is healthy.
- **Saved original data:** we keep a copy of what each source sent, so we can fix mistakes later without asking the source again.
- **Standard format:** prices, seller earnings (SDE), revenue, location and industry are all converted to one consistent layout.
- **Automatic updates and alerts:** the system updates itself on a schedule and warns us if a source stops working or changes.
- **Ready for duplicate removal:** we already store what is needed to spot the same business from two sources. In Phase 2 we switch on the matching and merge duplicates, and no history is lost.

Adding a new source later takes five steps: check its rules, add it to the source list, build its connector, test the results, and turn on its schedule. As a rough estimate, this takes about 1–2 days for a clean data feed and 2–4 days for a website without a feed.

5. History and Buyer Tracking

What we store	Why it matters
Listings from each source	What each source says, when we first and last saw it.
Change history	A permanent record each time the price, seller earnings, revenue, status or location changes.
Events	Plain milestones: listed, price lowered, price raised, status changed, relisted, removed.
Buyer activity	What each registered buyer searched for, viewed and saved.
Update log	A record of every update run, with counts and any errors.

Reports (Phase 3): price compared with earnings and revenue, how many listings are available, days on market, how fast new listings appear, price drops and broker activity. These can feed your market reports and content. We only mark a listing as "sold" if the source tells us so; otherwise it is recorded as "removed". **Buyer accounts:** Phase 1 includes sign-up, login, and a view of each buyer's activity. Phase 2 adds saved searches, instant email and text alerts, and buyer profiles (industries, locations, budget). Tracking people and sending texts require their consent. We build in consent and the ability to export or delete data, and your lawyer should prepare your privacy policy and terms.

6. What It Is Built With

Part	Tool	What it does for you
Data collection	Python with scheduled jobs	Fetches new listings automatically, on a schedule.
Data service	Django REST Framework	The engine behind the site: accounts, search, an admin panel, and automatic documentation.
Database	PostgreSQL	A proven, free database that stores listings and history and searches quickly.
Website	Next.js	A fast website that works well on phones and can be found on Google (where the source rules allow).
Hosting	Docker on a VPS; Cloudflare R2 for images	Low-cost hosting that you own and can move anywhere.

7. Phases, Price and Timeline

Phase	What is included	Result
Phase 1: Foundation	The collection system; CatchBuys; one more source; history tracking; the data service; buyer sign-up and tracking; the website; going live.	A working site that generates buyer leads and is built to grow.
Phase 2: Duplicates and Retention	Remove duplicate listings; saved searches; instant email and text alerts; buyer profiles.	A clean combined library and buyers who come back.
Phase 3: Growth and Reports	Add broker sources state by state; market reports and dashboards.	A regional marketplace with valuation insight.
Phase 4: Mobile and Insight	Mobile app improvements; price estimators; advanced investor profiles; connection to your broker CRM.	A complete platform with broad market coverage.

Phases 2–4 are scoped and priced separately after Phase 1.

Phase 1 stage	What is included	Time	Standard price
Stage 1: Data Engine	Source list and connector setup; standard format; saved original data; CatchBuys connection; cleaning of prices and details; history tracking; update log and alerts; check of CatchBuys rules.	2–3 weeks	$600
Stage 2: Data Service	Search and filters; sign-up and login; buyer activity tracking; admin panel to manage sources and view buyers; documentation.	2 weeks	$700
Stage 3: Website and Launch	Mobile-friendly website; image handling; going live on the server; scheduled updates; handover guides; **one more source, added once the system is tested**.	2–3 weeks	$800
		Standard price	$2,100
		Partner discount (20%)	–$420
		Phase 1 total	**$1,680**

Total Phase 1 time: 6–8 weeks. The price does not include fees charged by data providers. Adding the extra source depends on how quickly its provider gives us access.

8. Monthly Running Costs (Estimates)

Item	Per month	What it is
Server hosting (VPS)	$9 – $15	The computer that runs your site online. May go up if traffic and sources grow.
Dedicated Claude subscription (this project)	$17 – $20	A Claude Pro plan ($17 a month if paid yearly, $20 if monthly) used to help with maintenance, updates and code review.
Image storage, domain name, backups	$1 – $5	Listing pictures and routine safety copies.
Total running cost	**about $25 – $40**	
Data provider fees	**Set by providers**	CatchBuys charges are confirmed at the start and paid under your own account. Not included in the total above.
Optional maintenance	**$150 – $250**	Checking that sources keep working, fixing problems when sources change, and security updates. The first 30 days after launch are free.

Costs that start in Phase 2, such as sending emails and texts, are quoted when that phase is planned.

9. Ownership, Handover and Risks

You own **100%** of the code, the database and all accounts (server, domain, storage), which are set up in your name. You also hold the data agreements. At handover you receive the documented code, online testing pages for the data service, a one-step setup package so it runs anywhere, a plain description of the data, a guide for adding sources, and a manual for running the system day to day.

What could go wrong	How we handle it
Data rules: a source may limit what you can show or keep.	We check the rules at the start and build them into the system.
Duplicates until Phase 2: the extra source may overlap with CatchBuys, so a few listings could appear twice.	We store what is needed to match them, so Phase 2 can clean it up with no data lost.
Slow access: getting keys or agreements from a provider can cause delays.	We start those conversations on day one.
Changes at a source: sources can change their format without warning.	Automatic alerts and the optional maintenance plan; we prefer official feeds.

10. Next Steps

- Confirm the Phase 1 scope, price and timeline.
- Start Stage 1 and open the conversation with CatchBuys about access and terms.

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